

002. Chapter 2 Verses 1-10

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.1

सञ्जय उवाच ।
तं तथा कृपयाविष्टमश्रुपूर्णाकुलेक्षणम् ।
विषीदन्तमिदं वाक्यमुवाच मधुसूदनः ॥१॥

sañjaya uvācha
taṁ tathā kṛipayāviṣṭamaśhru pūrṇākulekṣhaṇam
viṣhīdantamidaṁ vākyaṁ uvācha madhusūdanaḥ

sañjayaḥ uvācha—Sanjay said; **taṁ**—to him (Arjun); **tathā**—thus; **kṛipayā**—with pity; **āviṣṭam**—filled; **aśhru pūrṇākulekṣhaṇam**—with eyes blurred with tears; **viṣhīdantam**—grief-stricken; **idaṁ vākyaṁ**—these words; **uvācha**—said; **madhusūdanaḥ**—Krishna

In this manner, when Arjuna was plunged in a state of despondency, with eyes blurred with tears, Lord Krishna addressed these words to him.

VERSE 2.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

कुतस्त्वा कश्मलमिदं विषमे समुपस्थितम् ।

अनार्यजुष्टमस्वर्ग्यमकीर्तिकरमर्जुन ॥ २ ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

kutastvā kaśhmalamidam viṣhame samupasthitam

anārya-juṣhṭamaswargyam akīrti-karam arjuna

Arjuna—O Arjuna!; **śhrī-bhagavān uvācha**—the Supreme Lord said; **kutaḥ**—wherefrom; **tvā**—to you; **kaśhmalam**—dejection; **idam**—this; **viṣhame**—in this hour of peril; **samupasthitam**—taken hold; **anāryajuṣhṭam**—unworthy; **aswargyam**—heaven-excluding; **akīrti-karam**—shameful

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Whence, in this critical situation, has this mental dejection takes hold of you, shameful and Heaven-excluding?

VERSE 2.3

क्लैब्यं मा स्म गमः पार्थ नैतत्त्वय्युपपद्यते ।
क्षुद्रं हृदयदौर्बल्यं त्यक्त्वोत्तिष्ठ परन्तप ॥३॥

klaibyaṁ mā sma gamaḥ pārtha naitat tvayyupapadyate
kṣhudraṁ hṛidaya-daurbalyaṁ tyaktvottīṣṭha parantapa

klaibyaṁ—impotence; mā sma gamaḥ—do not yield to; pārtha—O Arjuna!;
etat—this; tvayi—to you; na upapadyate—is not fit; kṣhudraṁ—mean;
hṛidaya-daurbalyaṁ—weak-heartedness; tyaktvā—giving up; uttiṣṭha—
arise; param-tapa—scorcher of enemies

**O Arjuna! Do not yield to impotence. It does not befit you.
Cast off this wretched weakness of heart. Arise, O scorcher of
enemies!**

VERSE 2.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।

कथं भीष्ममहं सङ्ख्ये द्रोणं च मधुसूदन ।

इषुभिः प्रतियोत्स्यामि पूजार्हावरिसूदन ॥ ४ ॥

arjuna uvācha

katham bhīṣhmam aham sankhye droṇam cha madhusūdana

iṣhubhiḥ pratiyotsyāmi pūjārḥāvari-sūdana

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **katham**—how; **bhīṣhmam**—Bheeshma; **aham**—I; **sankhye**—in battle; **droṇam**—Dronacharya; **cha**—and; **madhu-sūdana**—Shree Krishn, slayer of the Madhu demon; **iṣhubhiḥ**—with arrows; **pratiyotsyāmi**—shall I shoot; **pūjā-arḥau**—worthy of worship; **ari-sūdana**—destroyer of enemies

Arjuna Said: O Krishna! Bhishma and Drona are my teachers fit to be worshipped. How can I attack them with arrows in the battle?

VERSE 2.5

गुरुनहत्वा हि महानुभावान्
श्रेयो भोक्तुं भैक्ष्यमपीह लोके ।
हत्वार्थकामांस्तु गुरुनिहैव
भुञ्जीय भोगान् रुधिरप्रदिग्धान् ॥५॥

gurūnahatvā hi mahānubhāvān
śhreyo bhoktum bhaikṣhyamapīha loke
hatvārtha-kāmānstu gurūnihaiva
bhuñjīya bhogān rudhira-pradigdhān

gurūn—teachers; **ahatvā**—not killing; **hi**—certainly; **mahā-anubhāvān**—noble elders; **śhreyah**—better; **bhoktum**—to enjoy life; **bhaikṣhyam**—by begging; **api**—even; **iha loke**—in this world; **hatvā**—killing; **artha**—gain; **kāmān**—desiring; **tu**—but; **gurūn**—noble elders; **iha**—in this world; **eva**—certainly; **bhuñjīya**—enjoy; **bhogān**—pleasures; **rudhira**—blood; **pradigdhān**—tainted with

It would be better, indeed, to live on alms in this world rather than to slay these high-souled teachers. But if I kill them, even here I shall enjoy wealth and desires stained with their blood.

VERSE 2.6

न चैतद्विद्मः कतरन्नो गरीयो
यद्वा जयेम यदि वा नो जयेयुः ।
यानेव हत्वा न जिजीविषाम
स्तेऽवस्थिताः प्रमुखे धार्तराष्ट्राः ॥ ६ ॥

na chaitadvidmaḥ kataranno garīyo
yadvā jayema yadi vā no jayeyuḥ
yāneva hatvā na jijīviṣhāmas
te 'vasthitāḥ pramukhe dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ

na—not; **cha**—and; **etat**—this; **vidmaḥ**—we know; **katarat**—which; **naḥ**—for us; **garīyaḥ**—is preferable; **yat vā**—whether; **jayema**—we may conquer; **yadi**—if; **vā**—or; **naḥ**—us; **jayeyuḥ**—they may conquer; **yān**—whom; **eva**—certainly; **hatvā**—after killing; **na**—not; **jijīviṣhāmaḥ**—we desire to live; **te**—they; **avasthitāḥ**—are standing; **pramukhe**—before us; **dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ**—the sons of Dhritarashtra

We do not know which would be the better for us: that we should conquer them or they should conquer us. Arrayed against us stand the very sons of Dhritarāshtra, after slaying whom we should not wish to live.

VERSE 2.7

कार्पण्यदोषोपहतस्वभावः
पृच्छामि त्वां धर्मसम्मूढचेताः ।
यच्छ्रेयः स्यान्निश्चितं ब्रूहि तन्मे
शिष्यस्तेऽहं शाधि मां त्वां प्रपन्नम् ॥ ७ ॥

kārpaṇya-doṣhopahata-svabhāvaḥ
prichchhāmi tvāṁ dharma-sammūḍha-chetāḥ
yach-chhreyaḥ syānniśhchitaṁ brūhi tanme
śhiṣhyaste 'haṁ śhādhi māṁ tvāṁ prapannam

kārpaṇya-doṣha—the flaw of cowardice; upahata—besieged; sva-bhāvaḥ—nature; prichchhāmi—I am asking; tvāṁ—to you; dharma—duty; sammūḍha—confused; chetāḥ—in heart; yat—what; śhreyaḥ—best; syāt—may be; niśhchitam—decisively; brūhi—tell; tat—that; me—to me; śhiṣhyaḥ—disciple; te—your; aham—I; śhādhi—please instruct; māṁ—me; tvāṁ—unto you; prapannam—surrendered

(O Krishna!) My mind is distracted by the taint of pity and I am ignorant of what my duty is, and so, I ask you to teach me what is good for me. I am your disciple. I take refuge in you.

VERSE 2.8

न हि प्रपश्यामि ममापनुद्याद्
यच्छोकमुच्छोषणमिन्द्रियाणाम् ।
अवाप्य भूमावसपत्नमृद्धं
राज्यं सुराणामपि चाधिपत्यम् ॥८॥

na hi prapaśhyāmi mamāpanudyād
yach-chhokam uchchhoṣhaṇam-indriyāṇām
avāpya bhūmāv-asapatnamṛiddham
rājyaṁ surāṇāmapī chādhipatyam

na—not; **hi**—certainly; **prapaśhyāmi**—I see; **mama**—my; **apanudyāt**—drive away; **yach**—which; **śhokam**—anguish; **uchchhoṣhaṇam**—is drying up; **indriyāṇām**—of the senses; **avāpya**—after achieving; **bhūmau**—on the earth; **asapatnam**—unrivalled; **ṛiddham**—prosperous; **rājyam**—kingdom; **surāṇām**—like the celestial gods; **api**—even; **cha**—also; **ādhipatyam**—sovereignty

I can find no means to drive away this grief which is drying up my senses. I will not be able to dispel it even if I win a prosperous, unrivaled kingdom on earth with sovereignty like the demigods in heaven.

VERSE 2.9

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्त्वा हृषीकेशं गुडाकेशः परन्तप ।

न योत्स्य इति गोविन्दमुक्त्वा तूष्णीं बभूव ह ॥९॥

sañjaya uvācha

evam-uktvā hṛiṣhīkeśham guḍākeśhaḥ parantapa

na yotsya iti govindam uktvā tūṣhṇīm babhūva ha

sañjayaḥ uvācha—Sanjay said; **evam**—thus; **uktvā**—having spoken; **hṛiṣhīkeśham**—to Shree Krishna, the master of the mind and senses; **guḍākeśhaḥ**—Arjun, the conquerer of sleep; **parantapaḥ**—Arjun, the chastiser of the enemies; **na yotsye**—I shall not fight; **iti**—thus; **govindam**—Krishna, the giver of pleasure to the senses; **uktvā**—having addressed; **tūṣhṇīm**—silent; **babhūva**—became ha

Sanjaya Said: Having spoke thus, Arjuna, the destroyer of foes, finally said to Lord Krishna, “I will not fight” and became silent.

VERSE 2.10

तमुवाच हृषीकेशः प्रहसन्निव भारत ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये विषीदन्तमिदं वचः ॥ 10 ॥

tam-uvācha hṛiṣhīkeśhaḥ prahasanniva bhārata
senayorubhayor-madhye viṣhīdantam-idam vachah

tam—to him; **uvācha**—said; **hṛiṣhīkeśhaḥ**—Shree Krishna, the master of mind and senses; **prahasan**—smilingly; **iva**—as if; **bhārata**—Dhritarashtra, descendant of Bharat; **senayoh**—of the armies; **ubhayoh**—of both; **madhye**—in the midst of; **viṣhīdantam**—to the grief-stricken; **idam**—this; **vachah**—words

O king Dhritarashtra! Seeing Arjuna lamenting in the middle of two armies, Lord Krishna, as if laughing loud, spoke these words.